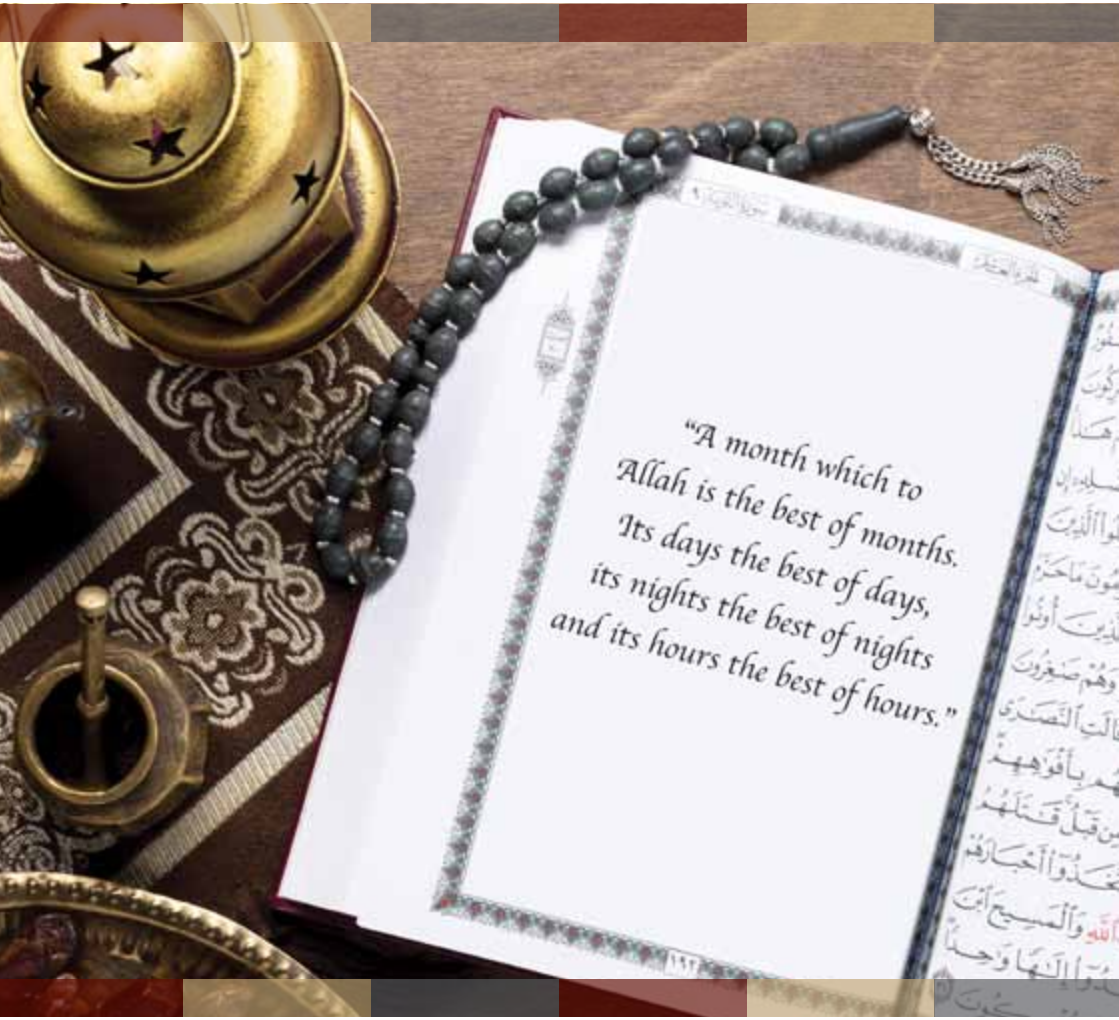
Sermon of the Prophet (pbuh)

ABOUT THE MONTH OF RAMADHAN



SERMON GIVEN BY THE PROPHET (PBUH) ON THE LAST NIGHT OF SHA'BAN ABOUT THE MONTH OF RAMADHAN

O people!

أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ!

Indeed ahead of you is the blessed month of Allah. A month of blessing, mercy and forgiveness.

إِنَّهُ قَدْ أَقْبَلَ إِلَيْكُمْ شَهْرُ اللهِ بِالْبَرَكَةِ وَالرَّحْمَةِ وَالْمَغْفِرَةِ،

A month which to Allah is the best of months

شَهْرٌ هُوَ عِنْدَ اللهِ أَفْضَلُ الشُّهُورِ،

its days the best of days, its nights the best of nights and its hours the best of hours.

وَأَيَّامُهُ أَفْضَلُ الْأَيَّامِ وَلَيَالِيهِ أَفْضَلُ اللَّيَالِي، وَسَاعَاتُهُ أَفْضَلُ السَّاعَاتِ،

It is the month which invites you to be the guests of Allah and invites you to be one of those near to Him.

هُوَ شَهْرٌ دُعِيتُمْ فِيهِ إِلَى ضِيَافَةِ اللهِ، وَجُعِلْتُمْ فِيهِ مِنْ أَهْلِ كَرَامَةِ اللهِ.

Each breath you take glorifies Him; your sleep is worship,

أَنْفَاسُكُمْ فِيهِ تَسْبِيحٌ وَنَوْمُكُمْ فِيهِ عِبَادَةٌ،

Your deeds are accepted and your duas are answered.

وَعَمَلُكُمْ فِيهِ مَقْبُولٌ وَدُعَاؤُكُمْ فِيهِ مُسْتَجَابٌ.

So, ask Allah, your Lord; to give you a sound body and an enlightened heart

فَاسْأَلُوا اللهَ رَبَّكُمْ بِنِيَّاتٍ صَادِقَةٍ، وَقُلُوبٍ طَاهِرَةٍ،

So you may be able to fast and recite his book,

أَنْ يُوَفِّقَكُمْ لِصِيَامِهِ، وَتِلاَوَةِ كِتَابِهِ.

For only he is unhappy who is devoid of Allah's forgiveness during this great month.

فَإِنَّ الشَّقِيَّ مَنْ حُرِمَ غُفْرَانُ اللهِ فِي هٰذَا الشَّهْرِ الْعَظِيمِ.

Remember the hunger and thirst of the day of Qiyama with your hunger and thirst;

وَاذْكُرُوا بِجُوعِكُمْ وَعَطَشِكُمْ فِيهِ، جُوعَ يَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ وَعَطَشَهِ.

Give alms to the needy and the poor, honour your old

وَتَصَدَّقُوا عَلَى فُقَرَائِكُمْ وَمَسَاكِينِكُمْ، وَوَقِّرُوا كِبَارَكُمْ،

Show kindness to the young ones, maintain relations with your blood relations, guard your tongue,

وَارْحَمُوا صِغَارَكُمْ، وَصِلُوا أَرْحَامَكُمْ، وَاحْفَظُوا أَلْسِنَتَكُمْ،

Close your eyes to that which is not permissible for your sight,

وَغُضُّوا عَمَّا لاَ يَحِلُّ النَّظَرُ إِلَيْهِ أَبْصَارَكُمْ

Close your ears to that which is forbidden to hear,

وَعَمَّا لاَ يَحِلُّ الْاِسْتِمَاعُ إِلَيْهِ أَسْمَاعَكُمْ.

Show compassion to the orphans of the people so compassion may be shown to your orphans.

وَتَحَنَّنُوا عَلَى أَيْتَامِ النَّاسِ، يُتَحَنَّنْ عَلَى أَيْتَامِكُمْ.

Repent to Allah for your sins,

وَتُوبُوا إِلَى اللهِ مِنْ ذُنُوبِكُمْ،

وَارْفَعُوا اِلَيْهِ اَيْدِيَكُمْ بِالدُّعَاءِ، فِي اَوْقَاتِ صَلَوَاتِكُمْ فَاِنَّهَا اَفْضَلُ السَّاعَاتِ،

And raise your hands in Dua during these times, for they are the best of times

يَنْظُرُ اللهُ فِيهَا بِالرَّحْمَةِ اِلَى عِبَادِهِ،

and Allah looks towards His creatures with kindness,

وَيُجِيبُهُمْ اِذَا نَاجَوْهُ، وَيُلَبِّيهِمْ اِذَا نَادَوْهُ وَيُعْطِيهِمْ اِذَا سَأَلُوهُ وَيَسْتَجِيبُ لَهُمْ اِذَا دَعَوْهُ.

replying to them during these hours and granting their needs if He is asked....

اَيُّهَا النَّاسُ!

O people!

اِنَّ اَنْفُسَكُمْ مَرْهُونَةٌ بِاَعْمَالِكُمْ، فَفُكُّوهَا بِاسْتِغْفَارِكُمْ.

Indeed, your souls are dependent on your deeds, free it with Istighfar (repentance);

وَظُهُورُكُمْ ثَقِيلَةٌ مِنْ اَوْزَارِكُمْ، فَخَفِّفُوا عَنْهَا بِطُولِ سُجُودِكُمْ وَاعْلَمُوا اَنَّ اللهَ اَقْسَمَ بِعِزَّتِهِ:

lighten its load by long prostrations; and know that Allah swears by His might:

اَنْ لَا يُعَذِّبَ الْمُصَلِّينَ وَالسَّاجِدِينَ وَاَنْ لَا يُرَوِّعَهُمْ بِالنَّارِ يَوْمَ يَقُومُ النَّاسُ لِرَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ.

That there is no punishment for the one who prays and prostrates, and he shall have no fear of the fire on the day when man stands before the Lord of the worlds.

O people!

One who gives Iftar to a fasting person during this month will be like one who has freed someone and his past sins will be forgiven.

Some of the people who were there then asked the Prophet (pbuh):

"All of us are not able to invite those who are fasting?"

The Prophet (pbuh) replied: "Allah gives this reward even if the Iftar is a drink of water".

O people!

One who has good morals (Akhlaq) during this month will be able to pass the 'Siraat'... on the day that feet will slip....

One who eases the workload of his workers in this month, Allah will make easy his accounting

أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ!

مَنْ فَطَّرَ مِنْكُمْ صَائِمًا مُؤْمِنًا فِي هٰذَا الشَّهْرِ، كَانَ لَهُ بِذَالِكَ عِنْدَ اللهِ عِتْقُ نَسَمَةٍ وَمَغْفِرَةٌ لِمَا مَضٰى مِنْ ذُنُوبِهِ.

فَقِيلَ: يَا رَسُولَ اللهِ، فَلَيْسَ كُلُّنَا نَقْدِرُ عَلٰى ذَالِكَ!

فَقَالَ (ص): اِتَّقُوا النَّارَ، وَلَوْ بِشَرْبَةٍ مِنْ مَاءٍ.

أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ!

مَنْ حَسُنَ فِي هٰذَا الشَّهْرِ خُلُقُهُ، كَانَ لَهُ جَوَازًا عَلٰى لصِّرَاطِ، يَوْمَ تَزِلُّ فِيهِ الْأَقْدَامُ.

وَمَنْ خَفَّفَ فِي هٰذَا الشَّهْرِ عَمَّا مَلَكَتْ يَمِينُهُ خَفَّفَ اللهُ عَلَيْهِ حِسَابُهُ

وَمَنْ كَفَّ فِيهِ شَرَّهُ، كَفَّ اللهُ عَنْهُ غَضَبَهُ يَوْمَ يَلْقَاهُ.

One who doesn't hurt others, Allah will keep him safe from His anger on the day of Judgement...

وَمَنْ أَكْرَمَ فِيهِ يَتِيمًا، أَكْرَمَهُ اللهُ يَوْمَ يَلْقَاهُ.

As for one who respects an orphan; Allah will honour him on the day of Judgement

وَمَنْ وَصَلَ فِيهِ رَحِمَهُ، وَصَلَهُ اللهُ بِرَحْمَتِهِ يَوْمَ يَلْقَاهُ.

And for the one who spreads his kindness, Allah will spread His mercy over him on the day of Judgement.

وَمَنْ قَطَعَ رَحِمَهُ قَطَعَ اللهُ عَنْهُ رَحْمَتَهُ يَوْمَ يَلْقَاهُ.

As for the one who cuts ties of relation; Allah will cut His mercy from him....

وَمَنْ تَطَوَّعَ فِيهِ بِصَلَاةٍ، كَتَبَ اللهُ لَهُ بَرَاءَةً مِنَ النَّارِ.

Who so ever performs a mustahab salaa in this month; Allah will keep the fire of hell away from him.

وَمَنْ أَدَّى فِيهِ فَرْضًا،

Whoever performs a wajib prayer;

كَانَ لَهُ ثَوَابَ مَنْ أَدَّى سَبْعِينَ فَرِيضَةً فِيمَا سِوَاهُ مِنَ الشُّهُورِ.

Allah will reward him with seventy prayers in this month.

وَمَنْ أَكْثَرَ فِيهِ مِنَ الصَّلَاةِ عَلَيَّ، ثَقَّلَ اللهُ مِيزَانَهُ يَوْمَ تَخِفُّ الْمَوَازِينُ.

And who so ever prays a lot during this month will have his load lighten on the day of accounts.

He who recites one aya of the holy Qur'an will be given the rewards of reciting the whole Qur'an during other months.

وَمَنْ تَلَا فِيهِ آيَةً مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ، كَانَ لَهُ مِثْلَ أَجْرِ مَنْ خَتَمَ الْقُرْآنَ فِي غَيْرِهِ مِنَ الشُّهُورِ.

O people!

أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ!

Indeed, in this month the doors of Janna are open,

therefore, ask Allah not to close them for you;

إِنَّ أَبْوَابَ الْجِنَانِ فِي هٰذَا الشَّهْرِ مُفَتَّحَةٌ، فَاسْأَلُوا رَبَّكُمْ أَنْ لَا يُغْلِقَهَا عَلَيْكُمْ،

The doors of Jahannam are closed,

so ask Allah to keep them closed for you.

وَأَبْوَابَ النِّيرَانِ مُغْلَقَةٌ، فَاسْأَلُوا رَبَّكُمْ أَنْ لَا يَفْتَحَهَا عَلَيْكُمْ،

During this month Shaytan is imprisoned;

so, ask your Lord not to let him have power over you.

وَالشَّيَاطِينُ مَغْلُولَةٌ، فَاسْأَلُوا رَبَّكُمْ أَنْ لَا يُسَلِّطَهَا عَلَيْكُمْ.

Imam Ali (pbuh) says that I stood up and asked:

قَالَ أَمِيرُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ (ع) — فَقُمْتُ وَقُلْتُ:

"O Prophet! What are the best deeds during this month?"

يَا رَسُولَ اللهِ! مَا أَفْضَلُ الْأَعْمَالِ فِي هٰذَا الشَّهْرِ؟

The Prophet (pbuh) replied:

"Stopping oneself from doing those deeds which are forbidden by Allah..."

فَقَالَ (ص): يَا أَبَا الْحَسَنِ! أَفْضَلُ الْأَعْمَالِ فِي هٰذَا الشَّهْرِ، الْوَرَعُ عَنْ مَحَارِمِ اللهِ.